

❖ What is government?

- A government is the system that run a state or community.
- The body of persons that constitutes the governing authority of a political unit or organization.
- Government the system or group of people governing an organized community, generally a state.
- Government is the institution through which a society makes and enforces its public policies.
- The institutions and processes through which public policies are made for society.

❖ What is politics?

- “Man is by nature a political animal”.
- Politics is the authoritative allocation of resources.
- Politics is that who gets what, when and how.
- Politics is the sign of who gets what, when and why.
- Politics is the study of how people get what they want.

❖ Political science: Meaning, Definition, Nature and Scope.

➤ Traditional Definition:

1. **Paul Janet:** “Political Science is that part of social science which treats the foundations of the state and the principles of government.”
2. **Dr. Garner:** “Political Science begins and ends with the state”.
3. **Stephen Leacock:** “Political Science deals with the Government”.

➤ Modern definition:

1. **Harold Laswell:** “Politics is the study of influence and the influential”.
2. **David Easton:** “Politics is the authoritative allocation of values.”
3. **Catlin:** “Political Science is the study of the act of human and social control”.

❖ Difference between theoretical politics and applied politics:

	Theoretical politics	Applied politics
Nature	Theoretical and abstract	Practical and concrete
Focus	Examines political concepts, ideas, theories, and models.	Focuses on the actual implementation and practice of political theories and concepts.
Purpose	Aims to understand and explain political phenomena and systems.	Aims to influence and shape political processes and outcomes.
Methodology	Relies on conceptual analysis, comparative studies, and theoretical frameworks.	Involves policy analysis, public administration, lobbying, campaigning, and political strategies.
Output	Theoretical frameworks, academic research, and publications.	Policy proposals, legislation, political campaigns, and governmental actions.

❖ Nature of political Science:

Political science is a part of social sciences and therefore is different from that of physical sciences like physics and chemistry.

So, the question which concerns the nature of the subject is whether political science is a science or an Art and how the nature of the discipline has undergone changes in the 20th century.

➤ Political science: An Art.

Political Science: An Art

Political Science শিল্প (Art) কারণ এটি মানুষের thought, experience, strategy এর উপর নির্ভরশীল। এটি Physics বা Chemistry এর মতো fixed rules মেনে চলে না।

- ✓ No fixed definition – Political concepts change with time & situation।
- ✓ Human behavior varies – এক rule সব জায়গায় work করে না।
- ✓ Experimentation is difficult – Lab test করে political truth পাওয়া যায় না।

◆ So, Political Science is not pure Science, but an Art based on intelligence & experience.

➤ Some arguments against the notion of political Science as a science:

- ✓ Lack of precise and standard definitions of terms and concepts.
- ✓ Complexity of political phenomena due to variation in the nature and habits of people.
- ✓ Diversity of 'environments' in which political developments take place.
- ✓ Problems of experimentation to arrive at valid conclusions.

➤ Political Science: As a Science.

Political Science: As a Science

অনেকে মনে করেন Political Science একটি বিজ্ঞান (Science) কারণ এটি facts, data, research এবং analysis এর উপর ভিত্তি করে গঠিত।

- ✓ Modern political theories – Voting behavior, election theories এখন data-based।
- ✓ Political experiments possible – যদিও lab experiment সম্ভব নয়, তবে social experiments করা যায়।
- ✓ Government is a continuous experiment – নতুন laws, policies তৈরি করে results বিশ্লেষণ করা হয়।
- ✓ Predictions possible – Social research এর মাধ্যমে কিছু political outcomes অনুমান করা যায়।

◆ So, Political Science is partially a Science as it follows systematic study & analysis.

certain extent.

❖ Changing dynamics of the meaning and nature of political science.

- A. After the World War-II, the meaning and nature of political science have undergone a sea change.
- B. Now political science is closely related to all aspects of social relations, rather than an activity centered on the institutions of government.
- C. So, the aims and objectives of political science have changed due to factors such as the rise of the power theory and behaviouralism. New understanding of Political Science.
- D. Political science has ceased to be merely the science of state-craft.

- E. Political science is concerned with all facets of power relations and human behavior having political implications in the society.
- F. Politics is portrayed as a process of conflict resolution, in which rival views or completing interests are reconciled for the benefit of all.

❖ **Scope of Political Science: political science as a discipline deals with various aspects like:**

- A. **Study of state and government**-it deals with the nature and formation of the state and tries to understand various forms and functions of the government.
- B. **Study of associations and institutions**-in organized way the fundamental problems of political science include, first an investigation of the origin and the nature of the state. Second, an inquiry into the nature, history and forms of political institutions and Third, deduction.
- C. **Study of national and international problems**- modern demands of defense of territory, representative government and national unity have made political science not only the science of political independence but that of state sovereignty also.
- D. **Study of political behavior of man**- it may be said that the character of political science in all its parts is determined by its pre-supposition regarding man.
- E. **Study of past, present and future of development**- political science attempts to explain the meaning and the essential nature of the state and deals with the laws of its progress and development within itself and in relation to international organizations and other states.
- F. **Study of the concepts of power, authority and influence** – with the behavioral revolution the central topic for study has become the study of power.

Scope of Political Science - (SAN PPP)

A. Study of State and Government

Example: Bangladesh's Parliamentary System – The roles of the Prime Minister and the President.

B. Study of Association and Institution

Example: Election Commission of Bangladesh – Managing elections and political party activities.

C. Study of National and International Problems

Example: Rohingya Refugee Crisis – A national and international issue for Bangladesh.

D. Study of Political Behavior of man

Example: 2018 National Elections – Voter behavior and election trends.

E. Study of past, present and future Development

Example: Economic Development of Bangladesh – The growth of the economy and the government's role.

F. Study of Power, Authority, and Influence

Example: Power of the Prime Minister – Use of power during emergency situations.